Mini Assessment

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Q1. If an API returns 429, what should your program do?

A) If an API returns 429, it means too many requests have been sent within the allowed time. The program should wait and retry only when it is appropriate.

→ Check the response headers for a Retry-After instruction.
→ Wait for the indicated duration before sending another request.
→ When no retry time is given, increase the waiting time after each failed attempt.
→ Set a maximum number of retries and avoid continuously calling the API.
→ If the limit is not cleared, report the problem clearly and save it in the logs.

Q2. If response.json() fails, what should your program do?

A) response.json() may fail if the server sends invalid JSON or a response that is not JSON at all. The program should handle this possibility.

→ Wrap the parsing operation in try-except to catch decoding errors.
→ Check the HTTP response status to identify server-side or client-side errors.
→ Verify that the response body contains data in the expected format.
→ Use the response text for troubleshooting rather than assuming JSON was received.
→ Give a safe error message or fallback result and continue execution normally.

Q3. If a JSON key is missing, why might .get() be safer than []?

A) Accessing data with ['key'] causes KeyError when that key does not exist. The .get() method can retrieve the value safely and can also provide a default.

→ It avoids an exception when a key is missing from the JSON object.
→ For example, data.get('message', 'No message') returns a default if needed.
→ It is useful when API fields are optional or may change.
→ The program can verify the returned value before processing it.
→ Therefore, get() makes reading JSON data safer and easier to manage.